

DNF showcased

Duke Nukem Forever gameplay shown off in Amsterdam; launch rumored to be in early 2011

Team Fortress 2 trading

Valve adds in-game trading of items for the popular Team Fortress 2 title

Agent 001

Laptop within budget of ₹40,000

I want to buy a lappie. My budget is 40k and I want a config that includes a 500 GB HDD, 4GB RAM and Core i3 or i5 (which ever is better). Can you suggest which one to go in for?

Rahul Sahu

A Look at the Dell Inspiron 15 series. There are plenty of models in your price range. You should be able to find Core i5 430M processor configuration with a 500GB drive for a tad over the ₹40,000 mark.



Dell's Inspiron 15 series offer good bang for your buck.

Phone under ₹6,000

I want to buy a mobile for around ₹6000 and I am confused between Nokia X2 and Samsung Champ. Which one is better and does the Champ have a long lasting touchscreen? Any other phone with similar features would do as well.

Rishab Garg

A Samsung Champ has a resistive touch screen which is not the best as after prolonged usage you will have to press the screen to generate a response. It has a mediocre 1.3MP camera. On the other hand, Nokia X2 has a regular keypad with a 5MP camera. Also X2 supports Push mail and IM which is a nice addition.

As far as pricing goes X2 is around ₹5,000 and Champ is around ₹4,000. Looking at the specs it's safe to go with the Nokia model. Both are not 3G compliant. Another interesting phone is the Intex IN 6633 which is a QWERTY phone

which has WiFi with a 2 MP camera and is priced at around ₹4,000.

Want to buy a LCD monitor-TV

I want to buy full HD monitor with a screen size between 22 to 24 inches. It should have inbuilt TV plug. My budget is stretchable up to ₹12,500. If possible suggest one with 2ms response time and an LED screen. The TV plug is a must while response time is not so important. My preference is towards the following brands:

Benq, Asus, Acer, Samsung

Vishal Karade

A If you want to use composite or component connections to connect your DTH set top box to your LCD monitor, then there aren't any options in your price range. Very basic 24-inch LCD monitors start from around that price range. There are very few displays with TV tuners built into them. The few that have it are priced that high.

Look for the Samsung P2370MS if you can stretch the budget up to ₹15,000 or so. It's a monitor with all the video connectivity options you'll need for a DTH set top box, gaming console or PC. It has built-in speakers as well.

Memory related queries

I wanted to inquire about the process for upgrading the RAM in my Desktop. The PC config is as follows:

Intel Pentium 4, 256 MB DDR2, 80 GB Hard Drive at 7200 rpm, Windows XP Home Edition.

Also, I would like to know about the factors that determine the maximum limit to which RAM can be upgraded. What does MHz have to do with RAM? What would happen if I just upgraded to 4 GB even if my PC supports only 2?

Mrinal Dhar

A The maximum limit upto which PC RAM can be upgraded depends on the motherboard itself, and a little bit on the chipset used. The MHz denotes the speed



The Samsung P2370 has all the video connectivity options you would ever need.

of the memory, not the capacity. Faster the memory, the slightly higher performance you get. Faster RAM also allows you space to overclock your system. If you put in more RAM than the motherboard supports, you'll most likely hear error beeps. For your system, you can spend ₹2,000 on a 2 GB RAM stick.

Laptop suggestions required

I have been a regular reader since 2003 and now I need your help to buy a laptop. My budget is ₹60,000 and I need a laptop with good build quality. My requirements are- Intel i7 6MB Cache, 1 GB graphics DX11 (Switchable graphics if available) 15.6" HD screen with the highest possible resolution, a 7200 rpm HDD (or SSD), 250 GB. SATA 3 would be preferred. RAM - 4 GB DDR3. Instant on feature is a must. At least one USB 3.0 port, Finger print scanner, DVD or Blu-ray drive

Navneet

A The configuration you're demanding is difficult to find at ₹60,000. The closest models we can suggest are the Lenovo Y560 (59-055616) and HP DV6 (3050TX). They both come with similar configurations as you would like. There are currently no laptops in this price range with SSD drives in them. USB 3.0 and Blu-ray drives are also missing. USB 3.0 is somewhat new and not all manufacturers have updated their configurations. Increasing your budget by another ₹15,000 should get you laptops with SSD and Blu-ray drives though. 